

THE 3 MOMENTS THAT DETERMINE ADVANCEMENT

The Introverted Leader — companion to the masterclass

Visibility isn't a personality trait. It's a skill — and it plays to introvert strengths: preparation, precision, and depth.

Most careers are decided in a handful of moments, not across hundreds of days of output. Introverts over-invest in the output and under-invest in the moments. Here's where to put the practice.

MOMENT 1 — THE PERFORMANCE CONVERSATION

The real conversation — not the annual review form. The one where you advocate for yourself and make the case for what's next.

- **The mistake:** letting your manager lead. Answering questions instead of making your case.
- **The skill:** prepare three specific contributions with outcomes attached — and open the conversation with them.
- **Start this week:** name one contribution — short, factual, non-boastful — at your next 1:1. By review time, your case is already on record.

MOMENT 2 — THE CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ROOM

Any meeting with other teams, other levels, other functions. The crucible of influence — where reputations are made, or opportunities missed.

- **The mistake:** going quiet to save energy. Getting caught up in the trivia.
- **The skill:** prepare one question or one point before every meeting like this. It's fine to speak less — but make it count.
- **The counterintuitive hack:** volunteer to lead the meeting. When guiding the conversation is your role, "when do I break in?" disappears.

MOMENT 3 — THE INFORMAL INFLUENCE MOMENT

The hallway, the lunch, the off-agenda conversation. Not networking — relationship.

- **The mistake:** skipping these because they feel like performance — saving yourself for the format where you're weakest, and avoiding the one where you're strongest.
- **The skill:** one genuine, prepared conversation a week with someone whose opinion of your work matters. Prepared doesn't mean scripted: a few bullet points in advance, then show up curious.
- **Remember:** one-on-one is the introvert's strongest ground. Trust is currency, minted one conversation at a time.

THE PRACTICE

Once a quarter, identify the 3–5 moments coming up where visibility matters most — and prepare for those specifically. Stop trying to be "on" all the time. Pick your spots.

Always on the list: **naming your contributions as they happen · one real conversation a week**

DO IT NOW

Your next moment is probably already on your calendar. Write it down:

My next moment: _____ Date: _____

What I'll bring to it (one point, or three contributions): _____

"I didn't become more extroverted. I became more intentional."

— Lissa Appiah, promoted five times in eight years

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